

65536 ports on a machine in order to see if anybody is listening on those ports.

POP3 or Post Office Protocol 3

A protocol that provides a simple, standardised way for users to access mailboxes and download messages to their computers.

Prepender

A virus that inserts a copy of its code at the beginning of the code of its victim file is known as a prepender or prepending virus.

Probe Tool

A tool that explores another system, looking for vulnerabilities. While these can be used by security managers, wishing to tighten up their security, the tools are as likely used by attackers to evaluate where to start an attack.

Proof of Concept, POC

It is commonly used to describe a virus that is the first to infect a given platform or implement a given infection technique.

Password Attacks

A password attack is an attempt to obtain or decrypt a legitimate user's password. Hackers can use password dictionaries, cracking programs, and password sniffers in password attacks. Defense against password attacks is rather limited, but usually consists of a password policy including a minimum length, unrecognisable words, and frequent changes.

Password Sniffing

The use of a sniffer to capture passwords as they cross a network. The network could be a local area network, or even the Internet itself. The sniffer can be hardware or software. Most sniffers are passive and only log passwords. The attacker must then analyse the logs later.

Piggyback

To gain access to a system via an authorised user's connection.